

CONNECTING AFRICA – THE AFCFTA WAY: A STRATEGIC PRIVATE SECTOR DIALOGUE CONVENED BY THE AFDB AND THE CASABLANCA FINANCE CITY AUTHORITY (CFCA)

WEDNESDAY 23 JULY 2025 - CASABLANCA (CFCA), MOROCCO

Casablanca AfCFTA Private Sector Call to Action

1. Unlocking the African Single Market for the Private Sector

Institutionalize private sector participation in AfCFTA implementation.

Action(s):

1.1. Establish the Casablanca AfCFTA Private Sector Platform to advocate for needed policy action/reform for AfCFTA, including:

- 1.1.1. «AfCFTA Business Catalyst» or A.B.C platform for data/market insights and intelligence, business guides, market entry strategies, Afropages for matchmaking.
- 1.1.2. Database of bankable projects (across sectors and geographies, curated pipeline of projects, including descriptions, data points, KPIs, type of financing needed).
- 1.1.3. Lead private sector collaboration in promoting AfCFTA.

2. Filling Infrastructure Gap

Promote private sector buy-in and capital for transport, energy, and logistics infrastructure for «Made in Africa».

Action(s):

2.1. Invest, through PPP models, in smart and green integrated economic corridors (road, rail, ports, digital infrastructure), aligned with regional development programs. These corridors should combine logistics efficiency, digital traceability, and climate resilience to catalyze intra-African supply chains.

2.2 Establish enabling environment, with conducive legal and regulatory framework to attract appropriate players – regional financial vehicles, investors, experts with appropriate project development teams, etc.

3. Regional Financial Integration

Mobilize finance to scale production and support regional capital markets.

Action(s):

3.1 Design and operationalize innovative financial products including fintech, regional letters of credit, bonds, crowdfunding, etc.

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3.2. Work towards legal and regulatory harmonization through broad regional cooperation between African stakeholders (stock exchanges, regulators, etc...) and support mutual recognition, and the operationalization of the African passport or AfCFTA passport.

3.3. Promote innovative financing mechanisms and instruments. Eg. Blended finance, pan African funds, diaspora bonds, green and sustainability-linked loans, and guarantee mechanism.

3.4. Advocate for increased capitalisation of African financial institutions to enhance their capacity to scale their support to the AfCFTA and its various stakeholders.

3.5. Leverage and repurpose financing from African pension funds and other sources to enhance the capacity of State Parties to implement the AfCFTA.

3.6. Advocate for a more active role of central banks in financing operations or interventions to advance AfCFTA implementation.

3.7. Direct investments into cross-border value chains.

4. Financial Centers and Business Hubs as drivers of AfCFTA Implementation

African financial centers as models to scale in accelerating AfCFTA implementation thanks to their clustering and catalyst effects.

Action(s):

4.1. Put in place a conducive business environment, legal and regulatory frameworks, mediation and arbitration mechanisms, streamlined processes to facilitate ease of doing business.

4.2. Advocate for harmonized regional legal and regulatory framework, through PublicPrivate Dialogue.

4.3. Attract and host complementary ecosystems and appropriate talent pool.

4.4. Raise awareness and promote AfCFTA opportunities through workshops, webinars, technical capacity building initiatives, etc.

The AfDB and CFCA will track implementation progress and mobilize technical partners to ensure the success of the Action Plan, each acting in accordance with its respective resources and mandates.